Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Means of Accomplishing Hevajra

Hevajrasādhanapañjikā · Toh 1233 · Derge Tengyur
ཀྱེ་རྡོ་རྗེ་སྒྲུབ་པའི་ཐབས་ཀྱི་དཀའ་འགྲེལ

The Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Means of Accomplishing Hevajra, known in Sanskrit as the Hevajrasādhanapañjikā and in Tibetan as Kye rdo rje'i sgrub pa'i thabs kyi dka' 'grel, is Toh 1233 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of commentaries on the tantras. It is a commentary of the pañjikā type, explaining the difficult points of a concise Hevajra sādhana attributed to the master Ḍombipāda, beginning with his homage to Heruka as the embodiment of the three bodies of a buddha. Line by line it unpacks the stages of the practice, from the generation of the deity and his maṇḍala, the six limbs of worship and mantra recitation, to the completion stage, the torma offering, and the rites of sleeping and rising. Its colophon names a Kashmiri author and records that it was translated into Tibetan by the eastern Indian paṇḍita Vanaratna together with the translator Shönu Pal.

In the language of India: hevajrasādhanapañjikā. In the language of Tibet: Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Means of Accomplishing Hevajra.

Homage to the noble bodhisattva Mañjuśrī in youthful form.

Having paid homage to Hevajra,
who turns the darkness of existence into day,
I shall explain a commentary on the difficult points
of his concise means of accomplishment.

Here, in order to pacify outer obstructors, the master Ḍombipāda praised glorious Heruka, the embodiment of the three bodies, the Dharma body, the enjoyment body and the emanation body, and paid homage to him, saying:

Though he has wholly abandoned all conceptual imagining,
from him, the one whose very nature is great skillful means,
comes the nature of all things:
to Heruka, the glorious protector, I bow.

As for "glorious Heruka": he is glorious because he possesses the accumulations of merit and wisdom, and so he is "glorious Heruka"; here the word meaning "possessing" has been dropped. The syllable he teaches compassion. The syllable ru teaches emptiness, in the sense that the

characteristics of such states as conceptual thought have been destroyed. The syllable ka teaches the form in which these are indivisible. Thus he is called glorious Heruka. Alternatively:

śrī is nondual wisdom;
he is the emptiness of cause and the rest;
ru is free of arrangement;
ka is abiding nowhere at all.

It is nondual because it is free of the grasped and the grasper. "he is the emptiness of cause and the rest" because, although eye consciousness and the others are produced by cause, condition and their auxiliaries, they are unarisen, and are therefore unconditioned. It is "free of arrangement" because it is free of both moving and unmoving. Since there is no substantial form, there is no state of having its own object; therefore, from its very form, which lacks intrinsic nature, comes the meaning of "abiding nowhere at all." "Protector" means one who has become the refuge of all beings.

As for "wholly abandoned all conceptual imagining": it is imagining, and it is total imagining, that is, the conceptualizations of the aggregates, elements and sense sources. To be free of these is to have abandoned them. Here the Dharma body, characterized by one's own aim, is spoken of. The word "though" has the sense of "also."

"The nature of all things": that body of the Blessed One, such as it is, displays bodies in accordance with those to be trained, through the power of his former aspiration prayers. They are things and they are all, hence "all things." Because they are characterized as arising from him, he is the nature of all things; here the enjoyment body is spoken of. Alternatively, "all things" are the tathāgatas, who are the purified aggregates, elements and sense sources; and since things have their aspect, they are all things.

If one asks, "From whom, then, does the nature of things come?", it says, "from him, the one whose very nature is great skillful means." It is means, and it is also great, hence "great means": the nature of compassion, which is able to bring in the realms of sentient beings, differing through the distinctions of their various dispositions, by means of the proliferation of infinite emanations such as the wheel of the maṇḍala. "The one whose very nature is that" is the emanation body, which is exalted by its perfect accomplishment of the aims of others.

Here there is the relation characterized as expression and expressed, and also as means and what arises from means. The collection of words of the means of accomplishing Hevajra is the expression. The means of accomplishing glorious Heruka, embodiment of the eight yoginīs, embraced about the neck by Nairātmyā, is the expressed. The relation is that characterized as expression and expressed; it is characterized as means and what arises from means. The purpose is that beings in whom attachment and aversion arise may enter. The attainment of its result, buddhahood and also the eight accomplishments, is the purpose of the purpose.

Now the main text itself will be explained. If one asks where a thing of this kind should be accomplished, the master states the special place, with "very hidden" and so on. "Some" means charnel grounds and the like. "Very hidden" means away from the stream of people. "On the ground" means at a certain spot of ground. "With musk and so on" means smeared with the substances of commitment: musk, camphor, storax, the four equal parts, rice-born, and the like. The connection is: there one should meditate on the yoga as follows. If one asks, having done what, it says, "on a soft seat" and so on. It is soft, and it is a seat, hence "a soft seat"; the meaning is a corpse seat, free of aggregates, elements and sense sources. "On it" means sitting close by its heart. "As follows" refers to the yoga about to be explained; "to cultivate" means to meditate.

The meaning is this. The yogin who strives to accomplish glorious Heruka should rise early, prepare a lotus with the five nectars, settle himself at the heart of a corpse in charnel grounds and the like, cast off the entire net of bad conceptual thoughts, and cultivate this yoga. It is yoga because it is to be joined: it is the special mark of supramundane formations, characterized by the abandonment of ordinary formations. And since this is said to belong to consciousness, the place where one focuses upon it is stated, with "at the heart" and so on. On a lotus arisen from paṃ, in the center of a moon disc arisen from the syllable a, is the seed of Akṣobhya, lord of mind: the syllable hūṃ, five-parted, of the nature of the five wisdoms that come from the purification of the five aggregates. By its rays, which are of the nature of discriminating wisdom, the body becomes nonexistent, being free of one and many. When that is so, there is no support, and so feelings, mind and phenomena are not established in relation to one another; therefore one should meditate on them as lacking intrinsic nature.

If one asks what the yogin should do once the ordinary body has been purified in this way, it says, "and one should also recollect the mantra." Immediately after meditating on the foundations of mindfulness, for the benefit of sentient beings, the mantra, namely the syllable hūṃ, is to be recollected, that is, brought clearly before the mind.

If one asks what is meant by the word "mantra":

Discernment by the mind
is also protection of the three realms;
from its nature of purifying the mind,
it is to be designated "mantra."

If one asks what is to be done after recollecting the mantra, it says, "By the light radiating from the pores, all beings without exception," and so on. With the lamps of light of the syllable hūṃ radiating from the yogin's pores, one sees the realms of sentient beings in the six destinies, oppressed by the sufferings of birth and the rest, and one should focus on great compassion; since this is easy to understand, it is not explained further. Then comes "as the cause of liberating them." "Them" means those beings who enter the six destinies. "As the cause of liberating them" means for the sake of whatever is the cause of liberating them, and that, the aim of what liberates them, is the increase of the accumulation of merit.

The means of increasing merit is stated with "the guru, the deity," and so on. The guru is an emanation of Vajradhara. The deity is the form of glorious Heruka. The victors are the emanations made by the light rays radiating from his pores. The bodhisattvas are in turn emanations of those tathāgatas. The assembly means those fully gathered together, and "together with them" means those who follow them perfectly. Having seen them, one should fully imagine offerings; the intent is that one should make offerings that are of the nature of the mind.

If one asks, from what, how, and with what should offerings then be made, it says, "first the mantra," and so on. This is a specification of the act: the mantra is the one that will be explained, oṃ vajra puṣpe āḥ hūṃ and the rest. "The seed of one's own heart" means that from the seed syllable hūṃ, which embodies the five wisdoms, come flowers, incense and the rest; that is, one emanates hosts of ḍākinīs and makes offerings with flowers and the like. This teaches the five offerings. Beginning with parasols, victory banners, flags and the like, and ending with human women and so on, together with their

accessories, it teaches worship by way of the seven precious things.

To the doubt as to where these substances come from, it says, "All arise from the jewel family": all the offering substances mentioned above arise from the jewel family, that is, they arise perfectly from the samādhi of the sky treasury. The connection is: one should make offerings with all of these, the secret ones and the others. Having taught in general, the secret offering is explained in particular: "Gaurī and the rest" and "the five nectars" and so on are to be understood according to the sequence taught in the tantra.

Having beheld in the sky the venerable glorious Heruka, then the guru, the others ranged before him, and others besides, one should make offerings by means of the eight goddesses, Gaurī and the rest, emanated from the rays of light of the seed syllable at the heart. On this it is said:

Gaurī holds the deer-marked moon;
Caurī, the vessel of the sun;
Vetālī holds water in her hand;
Ghasmarī holds medicine;
Pukkasī has the vajra in her hand;
likewise Śavarī holds the elixir;
Caṇḍālī is to beat the hand drum.
By these the all-pervading lord is worshipped,
passionately attached with great desire,
with Ḍombinī embracing his neck.

If one asks what is to be done after the offerings, it says, "One should confess one's misdeeds," and so on. One should confess misdeeds, rejoice in merit, dedicate, go for refuge, generate the mind set on awakening, and offer one's own self. If one asks how this is done: "First recite the verses." Having fully gathered all of these by means of the verses beginning "To the Three Jewels," then comes "Then, having received the command of the Tathāgatas, as the cause of acting for the benefit of beings." "Then" means immediately afterward: when the practitioner makes merit, he sees the tathāgatas appearing in response. For what purpose? "As the cause of acting for the benefit of beings," that is, one is to accomplish fully the welfare of sentient beings.

If one asks what is to be done once the command has been received, it says, "That which, without distinction among all beings," and so on. Because it is greater than the limited kind, it is great loving-kindness: since it protects all

sentient beings, it holds all beings without exception as an only child. Relying on beings who suffer from karmic results and the like, one generates compassion. Having generated compassion, one purifies the realms of sentient beings with the light from the heart and imagines them in the form of buddhas; the intent is that one should meditate on joy and generate it. "Then one should meditate on equanimity" means that one should then meditate on equanimity, a mind free of accepting and rejecting with regard to sentient beings, which is of the nature of the accumulation of wisdom: that is the intent.

That is the accumulation of merit. Then, to teach that the yogin should meditate on the accumulation of wisdom, the ultimate awakening mind of emptiness, it says, "Empty because free of intrinsic nature," and so on. Beings are of the nature of emptiness. Why? "Because free of intrinsic nature." According to the tenets of the Sautrāntikas, the reason is this: because, being dependent on others, they are free of one and many, and because no nature of their own is observed, they are free of intrinsic nature; therefore all things have as their nature the lack of intrinsic nature. So too it is said: "Subhūti, it is not that phenomena are empty by emptiness; rather, they are known through their own nature." This is the first door of liberation, and it is said to become the door of entry into the ultimate.

"Signless because causeless": what is not a cause is causeless, and therefore it says "because causeless." "Signless" means that when one analyzes ultimately, there is no such thing as a cause of beings. So too it is said:

Indeed, of all phenomena
no agent is observed;
if there is no agent,
actions too do not arise.

And elsewhere:

Not from self, not from other,
not from both, and not without a cause:
no things whatsoever, anywhere,
ever arise at all.

And:

Since whatever has no intrinsic nature,
how could it be another's condition by its nature?

How could what lacks intrinsic nature produce another?
This reason was taught by the Sugata.

When, upon further meditation, no cause of generation whatsoever is observed, by what could there be signs? This is the signless door of liberation.

"Since it is not made by one's own conception,
beings are also free of wishing."

Things, whether moving or unmoving, are free of wishing. Why? Because it is solely by one's own conception that they are divided in this way into the grasped and the grasper. So too it is said:

However very learned one may be,
when one's nature has been stirred up,
through dividing grasped and grasper
the single mind appears as two.

Thus they are perceived from being divided into grasped and grasper by the force of habitual tendencies. Therefore the partless emptiness that, in certain respects, together with aspiration, is qualified as ultimately unarisen is the wishless door of liberation.

"Then, having seen all as empty": having meditated on the door of liberation of emptiness through the special quality of the awakening of emptiness, one views the outer and inner self as empty. "At the very first one should recite the mantra": here "very" is a restrictive particle, so that, having first seen emptiness, one should recite the mantra.

If one asks what the intended meaning is: through meditating on the awakening mind of emptiness, the yogin's mind is cleansed and purified, which is characterized as the transformation of the basis. In keeping with this yogin come the gathering of the seed and the completion of the form through the awakening mind, and after that he also purifies others by means of the mantra.

In the mantra oṃ śūnyatājñānavajrasvabhāvātmako 'haṃ, the words oṃ śūnyatā are a pair, form and its lord: the white syllable oṃ, of the nature of mirror-like wisdom. The words jñāna vajra are the red syllable ā, of the nature of discriminating wisdom. The word svabhāvātmako is the black syllable hūṃ, of the nature of the utterly pure wisdom of the dharmadhātu. The word ahaṃ means "I am": this is the being of the intermediate state, embodying the three

wisdoms.

If one asks how there is a transformation of the basis from meditating on emptiness, entry into suchness is taught:

Peace, the nature of wisdom and means:
here that is the supreme reality.
Nondual wisdom is suchness;
this is the supreme awakening mind.
The basis is transformed,
all conceptualization abandoned;
it is supramundane wisdom
and also the dharmakāya of the Great Sage.

Someone may ask: if the awakening mind of emptiness becomes suchness, then, since the gathering of the seed, the completion of the form and the placing of the syllables are of the nature of things, how can they be suchness? The intended meaning here is this. Having protected oneself by the lights of the repha, the sun, hūṃ and the vajra, in the aspect of luminosity, there is the gathering of the seed, glorious Heruka, whose nature is the nonduality of the stable and the moving; there is the completion of the form, whose nature is the purification of the five aspects; and, by the very nature of the placing of the syllables, all the sense sources are purified. Since the emanation of glorious Heruka, lord of the desire realm, acts for the benefit of beings, the gathering of the seed and the rest are of the very nature of compassion; therefore there is no fault whatsoever in the awakening mind being suchness. As it is said:

From the mudrā, the cause, and freedom from union,
yoga becomes compassion and means.
Emptiness and compassion indivisible:
this is called the awakening mind.

"Then, from the sun, from the syllable hūṃ, the vajra tent that emerges from the mantra": "then" means immediately afterward. From the transformation of the repha one visualizes a sun disc in front; on it is a crossed vajra arisen from the syllable hūṃ, and by its rays one constructs the vajra fence, the tent and so on. Alternatively, from the transformation of the syllable hūṃ resting on the sun and the crossed vajra, one imagines Heruka in wrathful form, appearing in a two-armed body, destroyer of obstructors, terrifying with clenched fangs, holding a vajra peg in his left hand and a vajra hammer in his right. Then, with

the rays of his wisdom being, one summons the obstructors of the ten directions and stabs them with the peg: that is the intent.

If one asks what is to be done inside the tent, it says:

"One should imagine the transformed dharmadhātu,
and the palace too arises from the elements."

Beneath the tent, on the vajra ground emanated by the syllable hūṃ, is the triangular seal of the dharmadhātu, complete in the form of the syllable e, the basis of all the meanings of the words "stable and moving." Above it is the wind maṇḍala, transformed from the syllable yaṃ. Above that is the fire maṇḍala, arisen from the repha. Above that is the water maṇḍala, arisen from the syllable paṃ. Above that is the earth maṇḍala, arisen from the syllable laṃ. Above that, on a six-spoked wheel arisen from the syllable bhūṃ, by the rays arisen from the syllable a, one summons the being of the intermediate state described above into the womb formed by the two syllables hoḥ, and meditates that it becomes mingled as one with the syllable aṃ, saying oṃ vajra bīja svabhāvātmako 'haṃ. Then, the meaning is, one should imagine the palace arising from the transformation of the syllable oṃ, the wheel, and the wheels of the elements.

"Square, with four doors, adorned with necklaces, hanging strips and so on" is easy to understand. "There in the center a red lotus," and so on: there, in the center of the palace, from the transformation of the syllable paṃ, there is a form of desire and the like that accords with the seal of the source of phenomena; because it is of the very nature of great desire, its petals are red. One should imagine it with eight petals, that is, visualize it.

"There, resting on the anthers,
one should imagine the four māras."

The meditator, at the later stage, should imagine and consider that there, in the center of the anthers of the lotus, is the seat of the causal Hevajra: the four māras, placed beneath the soles of the feet of glorious Heruka, lying prostrate out of fear and stripped of their arrogance. Of these, the māra of the afflictions is of various colors, with one face and two hands, holding a noose with both hands. The māra who is the son of the gods is pale blue, rich in the charm of his own form, holding a flower arrow and a bow with his two hands.

The māra of the aggregates is black, holding an axe and a noose with his two hands. The māra of the Lord of Death is red, with a face of bared fangs,

holding a staff with his two hands. One should imagine that these are spread out as the seat and that one is seated upon them.

If one asks how, then, it is taught that their forms are to be meditated upon: that is true. They do not exist by intrinsic nature, but their forms are to be imagined in order to destroy the belief of people who believe in their birth.

Having taught the seat, the Blessed One taught in detail the seats of Gaurī and the others, with "Brahmā, Indra, Upendra, Rudra," and so on. The faces, hands, shapes and weapons held by these eight gods, Brahmā and the rest, are to be imagined on the eight petals exactly as they are well known in the world. The palace too should be visualized. By the mantra sarvvatathāgatanīlayavajrasvabhāvātmako 'haṃ one should understand the first limb, which is of the nature of Vairocana.

Now, so that the characteristics of form, luminosity and the rest may be examined one by one in one's own mind, it says, "The vowels and consonants, in the middle of moon and sun," and so on. The form of the moon transformed from the vowels is the vowel moon; the sun from the consonants is the consonant sun. In the middle, where these are perfectly joined, one should imagine the two seeds, the syllable hūṃ and the syllable aṃ, which embody wisdom and means. If one asks of what these seeds are to be meditated, it says, "by them a skull cup and a curved knife are to be emanated." If one asks what they become, they are blessed by their own seeds; the meaning is that the two emblems are marked by their own cause. It is said:

The result is sealed by the cause;
the cause is sealed by the result.

Here the nonduality of cause and result is taught.

If one asks what the intent is in meditating on the moon, the sun and the seeds, the purpose is stated: "There, the five aspects of full awakening are to be meditated upon with the knowledge of yoga," and so on. "There" means in that place: by the five aspects, namely the moon, the sun, the seed, the emblem, and one's own form, one should meditate, with the knowledge of yoga, on oneself as the fully awakened buddha. It is yoga because it joins. The knowledge of yoga is this: "Ordinary aggregates and the rest come to be practiced through the special quality of supramundane formations." The intent is that by this one should meditate on full awakening.

If one asks how, then, the ordinary aggregates and the rest are purified and generated, it is from what is taught in the explanatory tantra: "Someone said: Why are the very things by which one increases not prohibited in this? It is in the manner of burning firewood." And it says:

These aggregates are the buddhas;
these wisdoms are the families.
These ordinary embodied ones
are renowned as the mirror and the rest.

If one asks by which of these, the mirror and the rest, they become fully awakened, it says:

The mirror and equality wisdoms
are renowned as the moon and sun.

Since things are seen in full here in an aspect that is nothing other than a reflection, which makes all things seen and trusted, it has the property of a mirror; thus the mirror is the moon. Mirror-like wisdom: what accords with the reflection of dependent origination is the mirror wisdom, the aggregate of form. From its purification comes the moon, which has the nature of the doubled vowels. The moon-like mind, explained as the luminous mind, fully liberated from sorrow, dispelling the cataract of conceptual thought, purified of all the stains of the afflictions, is the moon. Equality is things being alike in the aspect of reflections of phenomena: not dissimilar, of one taste, the aggregate of feeling. The sun-like mind, adorned with the doubled consonants, ka and the rest, through acting without interruption for the benefit of sentient beings, is the sun, because it dispels the darkness of ignorance. So too it is said:

Compassion that cares for sentient beings
arises perfectly and continually;
it is wholly filled with virtuous qualities
and surely subdues all afflictions.

In "by the seed and emblem of the deity," the word "seed" is singular because means and wisdom are nondual. The seed is the causal Heruka, the deity to be explained later, and whatever are the emblems of the deities are to be stated, that is, explained, as having the characteristic of discernment. The meaning is this: one's own emblem, transformed from one's own seed, is the form of the purified aggregate of perception, characterized as the stage of complete buddhahood, the unsurpassed conduct of Samantabhadra. Because it discerns individually the aggregates of the sentient beings to be trained, who have

various dispositions, it is called "discriminating." It is said again:

The conduct of awakening, and likewise the grounds,
wisdom pure and free of defilement:
that abides between the two maṇḍalas;
regard it as one's own emblem.

"All as one: diligence." The undifferentiated form of moon, sun and seeds is explained as the dharmakāya, the nature of all buddhas, unborn, unmade and without support. Because the realm of sentient beings abides fully in it, it is activity; and because it abides in accordance with that, it is diligent activity, the reversal of ordinary formations. In the word "diligence" the preceding word has been dropped, just as "fear" is said for "true fear." Thus, by saying "diligence," "diligent activity" is meant. So too it is said:

The body of the buddhas
is without appearance and without support,
unborn, unmade and pure,
entirely free of nonexistence and the rest,
unbroken, indivisible, ungraspable:
the dharmakāya of the Great Sage.

In "complete, the purified nature of reality," "complete" means arising: the fully complete aspect of the Blessed One, the glorious causal Vajra, in accord with the beings to be trained, explained as the sambhogakāya. That is the purified nature of reality.

Here, summarized by the four lines before and after, it is "the purified nature of reality." The two preceding words, "utterly" and "fully," are to be taken from the very stem of the word "pure"; and since the word "very" is understood to indicate only that something is missing, the words "wisdom of the expanse" are also to be supplied. It is not merely the wisdom of the utterly pure dharmadhātu: the meaning is the body of the deity, which is the transformed aggregate of consciousness, endowed with the supremacy of all aspects. It is said again:

Why say the practitioner of the Blessed One
should meditate on a reflection?
One should meditate on Vajrasattva,
endowed with the supremacy of all aspects.

By these, completion through the five aspects is praised. It is said again:

Realizing the secret domain
of body and likewise of speech,
fully awakened through the five aspects,
supremely beautiful in all aspects.

If one asks how Vajrasattva, who thus embodies the five wisdoms, comes about, it says, "Having emanated and gathered," and so on. The meaning is this: from that melted form, the form without beginning or end, luminous by nature, one should meditate, by means of garlands of light rays, on a white five-pronged vajra; by emanating light rays one purifies the realms of sentient beings without exception and then gathers them back into it. Vajra means indivisible, because it is primordially unborn. It is "being" because it is the very cause of beings. The nature of non-abiding nirvāṇa is Vajrasattva. "Oneself becomes" means one becomes its form; this is a particular of the yogin. Therefore it is said that the yogin becomes like that.

If one asks in what aspect he becomes it: "Emblems, faces and the rest like the son." The son is so called because he extends the family; he is of the nature of the resultant Hevajra, the emanation body. This is because, through various means, he extends the continua of various sentient beings, and so does the work of a son. "Son" means one is to be indicated by emblems, faces and so on resembling his. The particular is "the light of moon, crystal and jewel," that is, the body is white in color. So too it is said:

Immediately upon the vajra's transformation,
one should imagine Vajrasattva,
endowed with the supremacy of all aspects,
with the light of moon, crystal and jewel.

Now, to teach the union of means and wisdom in great passion, in order to generate the variety that is the nature of the wheel of the maṇḍala, it says:

"Through joy, the couples in union,
one should gather all the buddhas."

Joy is great passion. Its sign is division into pairs, that is, the joining of the two organs. To enter into union in this way is to enter accordingly. The buddhas are Vairocana and the others, whose nature is the five great elements purified. "One should gather them" means this: when, while it is being focused upon through purified wisdom and means, ultimate great bliss has entered the drop of conventional awakening mind, one makes it into a form of one taste. It is also said in the tantra:

Through the union of bola and kakkola,
by the habitual tendency of hardness from touch:
because hardness is delusion, the self of phenomena,
delusion is held to be Vairocana.
Since the awakening mind is melting,
melting is held to be the water element.

This and the rest I have not explained, because it is the great secret.

Alternatively, "through joy, the couples in union" is not taught for the sake of passionate sentient beings to be trained, as is shown by the words here, "one should gather all the buddhas." The meaning is that, by the sound of great passion, the buddhas are summoned and enter the mouth; they are brought out by the path of the vajra and, inside the lotus of the goddess, are to be gathered as the very form of melted awakening mind and made to mingle as one. oṃ sarvatathāgatānurāgavajra svabhāvātmako 'haṃ: this is the nature of the passionate Vajrasattva, and it is the second limb.

Someone may object: "If the buddhas are only to be assembled and gathered, and not emanated, then the generation of the goddesses to be explained is not established." To this it says, "Through the union of what is churned and the churner," and so on. Wisdom, the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā in the form of Māmakī, is what is to be churned, and means, the Blessed One Heruka in the form of Vajradhara, is the churner. Their union is the aspect of the deity that is the remedy for dependent origination beginning with ignorance. It is union because they are joined. Therefore, by "through the union of the churner," completion as the deity through the thing rubbed and the thing rubbing is taught.

If one asks, "Is it then that, having passed out of the ultimate, one emanates the wheel of the goddesses?", it says, "He abides in the state of great bliss." Because it is the cause of great bliss, it is called great bliss, that is, the conventional. In "From the form of the awakening mind in the lotus," and so on, "in the lotus" means in the dharmadhātu, or within the anthers of the secret lotus. "The form of the awakening mind" means that all the buddhas, having first entered, became the very form of the melted drop of awakening mind. "Taking the forms of Gaurī and the rest": this teaches the taming of sentient beings in whom attachment and aversion arise. So too it is said:

In the form of women he controls the world;
in wrathful form he terrifies.

This teaches that those who follow the incarnations of Viṣṇu are summoned through wrath, and that sinful people are summoned.

From "Then Gaurī, black in color, holding a curved knife and a fish," up to "One should imagine her making the threatening gesture with her left hand, together with a vajra," it is easy to understand. As for gaṃ caṃ baṃ and the rest, the statement that the goddesses are to be drawn out by these eight seeds, gaṃ, caṃ and the rest, is made with regard to those of lesser faculties, since the lights and colors of the drop of mind also emanate according to differences of disposition. If one asks from where they are to be drawn out, the particular place is stated: "From the kakkola, in due order," and so on. "From the kakkola" means from the secret lotus. "In due order" means in the order of the directions, beginning with the east.

"With dance" means that joy has truly arisen when one has received the command of Vajradhara to act for the benefit of beings. "Upon a corpse" is to be construed thus: they are to be emanated upon those to be trained, Brahmā and the rest.

If one doubts, "How, then, are those whose nature is the awakening mind to be emanated from gaṃ, caṃ and the rest?", the answer is given as it is taught in the explanatory tantra:

"First imagine the male, and then
Emanate the circle of ḍākinīs.
With the vajra make love, and melt;
That too is made to drip and becomes the Victors.
Those eight seeds
Are the drops of the Tathāgatas:
gaṃ caṃ baṃ ghaṃ paṃ śaṃ laṃ ḍaṃ;
By these seeds draw forth the goddesses.
In Indra's quarter Gaurī, in Yama's Caurī,
Likewise in Varuṇa's quarter Vetālī,
In Kubera's the goddess Ghasmarī,
Likewise in Īśāna's Pukkasī,
In Agni's corner Śavarī,
In Nairṛti's the form of Caṇḍālī,
And Ḍombinī in Vāyu's:
In order, emanate the circle of goddesses."

From "Three eyes, the hair standing upward" up to "the eyebrows tawny" is easy to understand. On "Having visualized the circle in this way": the circle is the circle of goddesses. "Having visualized in this way" means having imagined them as distinguished by the three eyes and the other features. It is to be construed: "having emanated them, they melt together with the Lord."

The meaning is this. Then, one who desires nirvāṇa should meditate that, by the light rays of one's own heart, the gandharva being dwelling in space, enclosed within two red hoḥ syllables, enters fully into the consort by way of the mouth. It is also said:

"One should imagine it in the goddess's lotus;
This is called the gandharva being.
When the gandharva has fully entered,
Recollect the melting as emptiness."

On "The Lord together with the consort melt through great passion": "then together with the Lord" refers to the lord of the circle of the maṇḍala, whose nature is the three realms. The consort has the characteristic of discriminating all things. "Together" means that melting through nonduality itself is the attainment of sameness. From what? From great passion, that is, from great bliss; this is equivalent to saying "from entering into self-cognizing wisdom." Alternatively, "great passion" is the gandharva being, whose nature is the two red hoḥ syllables, the essence of the three syllables of body, speech and mind. It is also said:

"A syllable like the red syllable hoḥ,
In whose essence body, speech and mind abide,
Melted by the fire of passion:
This is called the melting of man and woman."

And again it is said:

"Having gathered them, emanate the circle of Victors;
Draw them forth properly with the mantra syllables.
When the gandharva has properly entered,
Recollect the melting and the descent."

"Of the gandharva of habitual tendencies": the gandharva is the being of the intermediate state. The meaning is that the melting comes about through its entering.

If one asks, "Well then, is this melting also an event like the melting of snow?", the text says, "Melted, like a vase of butter." "Melted" means that, together with the Blessed One Vajradhara, it has fully entered the state described as the ultimate Dharma body, free of the aggregates, the elements and the sense sources, and of grasped and grasper; and because it does not stir from that very moisture of compassion for beings, it is seen as like a vase of butter.

If one asks how, having melted, he is roused again, the text says, "Seeing that, Pukkasī and the others," and so on. "That" is the Blessed One melted together with the consort. "Having seen, Pukkasī first": Pukkasī and the others are the goddesses of the four corners, whose nature is the four abodes of Brahmā (brahmavihāras), forms of virtuous qualities arisen from the mind of the Blessed One Vajradhara. With sweet, that is, pleasing songs, they fully rouse him for the benefit of beings, that is, for the purpose of liberating people obscured by afflictions such as attachment; this is the reason.

The urging is as follows. "Arise, Lord, you whose mind is compassion," and so on: this is the urging by Pukkasī, whose nature is loving-kindness. The urging by Śavarī, whose nature is compassion, is what is said in "Without you I shall die," and so on. The urging by Caṇḍālī, whose nature is joy, is what is said in "Lord of joy, who tend the world as your guests," and so on. The urging by Ḍombinī, whose nature is equanimity, is what is said in "I know your compassion, a magical display," and so on.

On "By oṃ hūṃ, a curved knife and," and so on: when urged in this way, the Blessed One recollects his former aspirations and, entering into compassion, imagines at his heart, from the syllables aṃ and hūṃ, the two signs of skillful means and wisdom in the form of a curved knife and a skull cup. With their light rays he purifies the realm of beings without remainder, establishes them in buddhahood, and draws the rays back; they enter into those very signs that embody skillful means and wisdom, and emanate. The meaning is that, from the forms of the curved knife and the skull cup, the form of one's own deity, the wrathful seat, the mudrā, and the riding upon the māras arise from the melted form. As it is said:

"The sole in the middle, joined with the thigh,
The tip of the left foot on the variegated ground,
Without disorder and without reversal:
This mudrā is called the wrathful seat."

If one asks what this Blessed One, Hevajra as the result, is like, the text says, "Eight-faced and four-legged," and so on. He has eight faces because he has the nature of the eight liberations. He has four legs because he goes by the feet of the means of gathering. "Adorned with sixteen arms" is because of the purity of the sixteen emptinesses. "Rich in twenty-four eyes" is because each face is beautified by three eyes whose nature is the three wisdoms. The meaning is that the dark blue face bares its fangs because it devours the afflictions, the conceptions of form and formlessness.

"And on the right a white face": the right is the side of skillful means; it is white because it is the body vajra. The left, the side of wisdom, is red because it is the purity of the speech vajra; this is construed with "should be meditated upon." On "On the crown," and so on: the crossed vajra is the wisdom that accomplishes activities, and the meaning is that it is borne on the crown.

"Flowers of heads" and so on means that, having cut off the heads of the fifty-one formations, he is adorned, that is, decorated, with a garland of head-flowers that signifies the exalted formations. "Of the deity" and so on: the deity is glorious Heruka, and the meaning is that he bears the five Tathāgatas in the form of the seals that will be explained. "Skulls set upon the crown": kaṃ is great bliss, and "that which protects it" is the kapāla, that is, the Tathāgatas. From their purity, a diadem gleaming upon the crown is made of the skull pieces, the five segments.

On "Endowed with the sentiments, the erotic and the rest," and so on: by the erotic and the other sentiments it is shown that, with a courageous presence, he tames all the world-systems in which the erotic and the rest arise.

"Black in color" and so on: his body is black because it signifies freedom from all colors. This very one is utterly terrifying, confounding dull-witted people. By "wheel, earrings" and so on, it is shown that, being endowed with ornaments that delight people who desire ornaments, nonvirtuous things do not enter in. It is also said in the tantra:

"For the guru, the master and the chosen deity,
The wheel is worn out of reverence;
And for the guru, the vajra holder,
Earrings in the ears; reciting mantra
With the winds is the ornament of the throat;
The bracelets, for renouncing the killing of living beings;
The girdle, for relying on the mudrā.

In the form of the wheel is Akṣobhya;
The nature of the earrings is Amitābha;
The necklace is Ratneśa;
The bracelets are called Vairocana;
In the girdle abides Amogha:
Thus they are ascertained as the five seals."

The Blessed One so adorned, having mounted upon the back of Time, as explained before, threatens the gods and the asuras; it is stated definitively that he tames the vicious.

On "With half-crossed legs" and so on: this is by the particular way in which he abides in the character of nonabiding nirvāṇa. And he is seated "in dance": it is dance because he comprehends all the buddhas.

On "Nairātmyā, embracing his shoulders," and so on: the reality of selflessness is Nairātmyā. She is a woman because she has the character of wisdom. She embraces his shoulders, that is, his neck. She is described thus. If one asks how she is described: as emptiness free of all elaborations, the body pervaded by ultimate wisdom; that is the ultimate.

If one asks again how she becomes Nairātmyā in conventional form, the text says, "On the left, a skull cup and a khaṭvāṅga," and so on. She who exists as a nature without object and without elaboration appears otherwise, with form, like the weapon of Indra, in accordance with those to be trained. Holding the skull cup, the khaṭvāṅga and the curved knife, her left and right hands are beautiful. The purification of the skull cup and the rest should be learned from what is taught in the tantra. Nairātmyā is black in color because she is the purity of the syllable oṃ, and she is utterly terrifying in order to tame the vicious. The intention is that the yogin should meditate on her as having become the goddess because she is the cause of firmness at the gate of liberation, which is self-awareness.

"Endowed with ornaments like her lord": this shows her form to be inseparable from the Blessed One, glorious Heruka.

To make the particular implements of the lord known, the text says, "Elephant, horse," and so on. Because these signify diseases, he consumes them, having placed them in the eight skull cups, which, being without flesh and without blood, have become limbs of objectlessness. "The frightened" means those who are not heroes; "bears" means he holds them. "Right" means with the

hands; this is established from worldly usage, because it is said, "Treatises follow the world."

"Earth and water" and so on: those from earth up to the yakṣa have the nature of the eight lords (īśvaras). The meaning is that, having entirely rejected the tīrthika view that "they give by fulfilling the wishes of beings, but there is no result," they demonstrate, without regard for any result, the character of accomplished giving and of the giver.

For the purification of the elephant and the rest, and of earth and the rest, one should follow the explanatory tantra, for it says:

"The beings, the elephant and the rest,
Serve to pacify diseases of wind:
Cough, asthma, and likewise madness,
Consumption, leprosy and swollen legs,
Spleen and liver: having these natures,
They are known as the elephant and the rest.
And the eight, earth and the rest,
Are known as the eight lords,"

and so on.

On "Red eyes" and so on: the eyes are red from being the reality of compassion, passion and joy. "Tawny" describes him whose eyebrows are of utter luminosity; here the possessive suffix marks the end of a compound. "Hair blazing upward" is said of him whose hair blazes upward. The intention is this: it is an appearance emanated and raised up above the mind vajra by the force of the light of the wisdom being.

On "Then the yoga becomes oneself," and so on: the yogin is one whose meditation has developed, because by visualizing in this way all conceptual thoughts and ordinary habitual tendencies are exhausted. "He harms all the vicious" means he crushes all the māras. That in this very life one becomes manifest, as glorious Heruka, both to others and to oneself, and fully attains that state, is the benefit of the meditation.

"The wisdom circle, properly," and so on: then, with the light rays emanated from the syllable hūṃ, the wisdom being, above the vajra that arises from the syllable hūṃ resting on the lotus and sun at the heart of the wisdom being who dwells at the heart of the commitment being, one properly urges glorious Heruka, the wisdom being accomplished from beginningless time. Having

made offerings with the five nectars and the welcoming water, by reciting, that is, pronouncing, the mantra jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ, with the forms of Gaurī and the others and the mudrās of the hook, the noose, the chain and the bell,

"One's own circle" is the commitment circle; "one" means nonduality. "Make" means attain; the meaning is attaining buddhahood. As it is said in the explanatory tantra:

"The wisdom circle, blazing greatly,
Swiftly make enter the commitment circle;
Otherwise neither buddhahood
Nor the state of a bodhisattva is accomplished.
Or else summon it with jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥs:
Summon it by the four, Gaurī and the rest,
And also make it enter,
Bind it, and make it pleased.
Gaurī summons; Caurī
Binds with the noose; Vetālī
Binds with the chain; and Ghasmarī
Brings it under control with the bell."

That these four goddesses alone are able to summon the wisdom circle, and not others, is something to be asked of the gurus.

Having made the wisdom circle enter in this way, one should meditate on Bhūcarī, arisen from the family of Vairocana, produced from the transformation of hūṃ upon a lotus and a moon disk at his forehead: she is white in color, with one face and two hands, holding a curved knife and a skull cup in her hands, and abides in the half-crossed posture. Likewise, at the throat, from the transformation of the syllable āḥ, one should meditate on Khecarī, who is red; and likewise at the heart, Pātālavāsinī, born from the syllable hūṃ, who is black. With the light rays of the wisdom being at the heart one summons goddesses of the same form who dwell in space, and makes them enter these, at body, speech and mind. One recites: oṃ yogaśuddha sarbbadharmma yogaśuddho'haṃ oṃ sarbbavīrayoginīkāyavākacittasvabhāvātmako'haṃ. As it is also said:

"From the mantra oṃ āḥ hūṃ,
At body, speech and likewise mind,
One should imagine Bhūcarī and Khecarī
And Pātālavāsinī."

Now the purification of the faculties, the objects, the aggregates and the elements is taught. Someone may object: "If these things are impure, how can it purify them, since impurity is their very nature? And if they are pure, what is the use of saying that it purifies them? Since that would be powerless and pointless, nothing is gained." We reply: that is not correct. For it purifies things that are by nature entirely pure from their having been stained by the superfluous stains of grasped and grasper, just as with gold and the like. Purifying adventitious stains is something seen and well known in the world. As it is also said:

"Like the water element, gold and space,
Which are pure, it is held to be pure."

On "In the eye, it becomes Mohavajrā," and so on: "in the eye" refers to the eye faculty, the support of consciousness, which makes form clearly evident. The meaning is that there Mohavajrā, the antidote to delusion, whose nature is mirror-like wisdom and who arises from the family of Vairocana, has become, that is, has gone into, clear and stainless suchness. Likewise there are the ear faculty, the support of ear consciousness, which makes sound clearly evident, and in the same way the nose faculty, the tongue faculty, the body faculty and the mind faculty. These are to be purified by Mohavajrā and the others, who are the antidotes to delusion, aversion, avarice, attachment and envy, by being their very nature.

Having purified the faculties, it teaches the purification of the objects: "In form Gaurī, in sound Caurī," and so on. Here form is the domain of the eye faculty; it is to be understood by taking up the twenty-five things of color and shape. "Sound" is sound, the object grasped by the ear. It is of three kinds: pleasant, unpleasant, and neither. It is also of five kinds: sound commonly known in the world, sound taught by the proponents of tenets, imputed sound, sound designated in the conventions of the noble ones, and sound designated in the conventions of those who are not noble. Smell is what is grasped by the nose faculty; it is of three kinds: fragrant, foul, and neither. It is also of three kinds: innate, compounded and transformed. What is grasped by the tongue faculty is taste, of six kinds: bitter, sour, hot, astringent, sweet and salty. The tangible is the domain of the body faculty, of twenty-five kinds: smooth, rough, heavy, light, slack, cold, warm, hunger, thirst and so on. The form included in the dharma sense source, which is grasped by the mind, is alone of five kinds: that arising from aggregation, that having spatial occasion, that arising from taking vows, the imputed, and that arising from mastery. Thus the six sense sources

are to be purified by placing Gaurī, Caurī, Vetālī, Ghasmarī, Bhūcarī and Khecarī upon them in order. If one asks how the sense sources are purified, we reply: because these objects and subjects alone, by their very forms, extend far and wide, it is therefore also called the purification of the sense sources.

It teaches the purification of the aggregates: "The form aggregate becomes Vajrā," and so on. Here form has the characteristic of being suitable as form. Being suitable as form is of two kinds: suitable as form through contact, and suitable as form through examination of the object. Whatever, wherever it is touched by hands, feet, a stick and so on, is to be examined as soft, hard and so on, is suitable as form through contact. Whatever, as an object facing one, is to be examined individually as blue, yellow and so on, is suitable as form through examination of the object.

Feeling has the characteristic of experiencing. It is the maturation result corresponding to virtuous, nonvirtuous and neutral karma, and it is of three kinds: pleasure, suffering, and neither. Perception has the characteristic of perceiving: the perception of the seen, the perception of the heard, and the perception of the cognized. The perception of the seen is held to depend on the eye and form, and the perception of the heard on the ear; and the last is what one has realized for oneself.

The perception of the cognized is what is individually experienced. Formations have the characteristic of forming: whether virtuous or nonvirtuous, they are what make the mind engage in states of pleasure and suffering. Consciousness has the characteristic of cognizing: whatever cognizes forms, sounds, smells, tastes, tangibles and phenomena is consciousness, the consciousness aggregate.

Upon these the goddesses Vajrā and the rest are to be placed in order, in forms not other than Vairocana and the rest; the Tathāgatas become the forms of yoginīs. If one asks how, since these goddesses have aspects, the aggregates and the rest become of the nature of suchness, we reply: here the word "tathāgata" is not to be spoken of in the way of names like ḍittha and ḍibittha; rather, the Blessed One established it by etymology:

"The glorious one has gone into suchness,
And likewise has come just thus;
Endowed with wisdom, for this reason
He is designated 'Tathāgata.'"

Therefore "thus-gone" means either from having come into suchness or from having gone thus. All the goddesses, Mohavajrā and the rest, who are connected with the Tathāgata families, are as it were of the nature of suchness. "Into suchness, too": through the purity of all phenomena; and phenomena are to be purified only by the deities. As it is also said:

"The purity of all things
Is definitively declared to be suchness;
Afterward, by distinguishing each one,
It is to be expressed through the deities."

Now, it is said, "Whatever form there is, all of it is to be understood as derived from the four great elements." To establish that the great elements alone are the basis on which form is conceived, the text says, "Pukkasī and Śavarī," and so on: the goddesses of the four intermediate directions, Pukkasī and the rest, in forms not other than Locanā and the rest. "On earth, water, fire and wind": on solidity, moisture, heat and motion, which have the nature of Locanā and the others who are based on them. "In order to purify" means in order to comprehend the nature of reality just as it is. "The yogin who knows" is one endowed with the yoga of knowing, as reality, what is to be adopted and what is to be abandoned, and of meditating on it. "Are to be placed" means that one should regard these as forms inseparable from those goddesses.

"Then" means immediately after one has become free of the afflictive obscurations by meditating on purification. "Having abandoned, the empowerment of the Tathāgatas": if one asks, "From what?", a bodhisattva who practices the conduct by way of mantra, investigating "What is it that is called complete and perfect awakening?", is to know reality; that is the exhaustion of the obscurations to knowledge. Having said this, in order to teach the empowerment by the buddhas, the text says, "Lord of the maṇḍala circle," and so on. "Center" (maṇḍa) means essence: the ultimate awakening mind whose nature is great bliss. That which takes it up is the maṇḍala: the assembly of glorious Heruka and the goddesses emanated from the drop of the conventional awakening mind. It is a circle because it signifies that very thing as nondual and of one taste. "Its lord," that is, "in its form," is a qualification of the yogin.

"By light emanating from the wisdom seed" means that the deities emanated from the light rays of the syllable of the wisdom being above the mind vajra, abiding in the sky, supplicate the buddhas dwelling in space for the sake of

empowerment, that is, for the sake of blessing or for the sake of transformation; to supplicate means to request it. On "Those buddhas" and so on: "those" means by those who dwell in space, who have been supplicated by the light rays of the wisdom being. "In the form of Heruka" means with the bodies of Heruka arisen through the power of the yogin's devotion. "Gathered" means with the vases of nectar, by the rite of mantras and so on. "Empower" means empowerment to kingship, because it brings about the attainment of the benefit of all beings without exception.

On "Gaurī and the rest, and Locanā and the rest," and so on: the word "and" is conjunctive. Thus, just as the buddhas confer the empowerment, so the assemblies of goddesses of that maṇḍala, Gaurī and the rest and Locanā and the rest, make worship; the meaning is that they make offerings with dance, song, music and the sound of auspicious acclaim, and likewise with flowers, incense, lamps, perfumes, food, clothing, ornaments and so on.

If one asks with vases filled with what water the empowerment is conferred, the text says, "Filled with the five nectars," and so on: with vases filled, that is, completely full, with the five nectars, whose nature is the five wisdoms and whose characteristic is to dispel birth and death. "With a rain of flowers" means with a rain of flowers from the goddesses. The purpose is stated: "The yogin becomes empowered," and so on. Because all the buddhas confer the empowerment, the yogin is empowered into the nature of irreversibility.

"The crown ornament by the glorious mind: the crown ornament of Akṣobhya." The meaning is that the sign of Akṣobhya, which signifies the nature that cannot be moved from the pride of having attained the power to act for beings for as long as saṃsāra lasts, comes to be, that is, is to be obtained, upon the diadem. As it is said: having summoned with the light rays emanated from the seed at one's own heart those who have the form of light rays, and having pleased them, one should request the empowerment: abhiṣiñcantu maṃ. "You buddhas" means all the Tathāgatas. Then the bodies of Heruka produced by the Tathāgatas confer the empowerment with their own hands, with excellent vases filled with the water of the five nectars; and in the empowerments one seals his crown ornament with Akṣobhya: oṃ sarbatathāgatābhiṣekavajrasvabhāvātmako'haṃ.

Having taught the empowerment and sealing of the Blessed One, the text speaks of those of the goddesses: "Gaurī and Pukkasī too," and so on. Here the word "too" has the sense of "definitely." Thus Gaurī, whose nature is form, and

likewise Pukkasī, whose nature is earth, are to be sealed by the Lord of Mind alone, and not by another, Vairocana. Otherwise, the aspect of wisdom would be abandoned, and through that very fault of dullness there would be no accomplishment of the goddess; therefore Akṣobhya alone is stated. It is taught in this way in the tantra for all the goddesses, and the sealing should be understood in a manner that is not inverted.

On "Caurī and Śavarī," and so on: for Caurī, and likewise for Śavarī, it is the Lord of Body, Vairocana. Likewise for Vetālī it is Ratnasambhava: she is sealed by the lord of avarice. "Caṇḍālī's crown ornament," and so on: the crown ornament of her whose nature is fire is Ratnasambhava; "crown ornament" means by the lord himself. "Ḍombinī has the vajra of passion": the meaning is that the sealing of her whose nature is envy is by Amitābha, the holder of the vajra of passion. "Ghasmarī too, in the place of empowerment": in Ghasmarī's place of empowerment it is likewise Amitābha, because discerning wisdom is the chief of the vajra empowerment.

On "Knowing yoga": yoga is realizing the conventional and the ultimate as inseparable. Here the form of the deity that is to be sealed is the conventional, and the sealing by the Tathāgatas is the ultimate. The aspect in which they are of one taste is union, and to know that is "knowing yoga." "Always" means never apart from familiarization. "Should be meditated upon" means "should be kept in mind"; that is the intention. As it is also said:

"Knowing the families thoroughly,
And sealing, the deity is accomplished;
From a yoga that meditates with the families confused
There is no accomplishment, and no accomplisher."

On "Then, having made offerings, oneself," and so on: "then" means that immediately after the empowerment one should make offerings. Here, with the welcoming water, flowers, incense, lamps, perfumes, food, garments, ornaments and so on, held by the eight goddesses emanated by the light rays of wisdom from one's own heart and mutually inseparable from oneself, one should make offerings, properly knowing the object of offering, the one who offers and the offerings to be mere reflections whose nature is without any object; and one should recite oṃ sarbbatathāgatapūjāvajrasvabhāvātmako'haṃ. As it is also said:

"With the various articles of wisdom
Emanated by the eight goddesses,

One should make offerings in the presence
Of the maṇḍala and of oneself, the lord of the maṇḍala."

"By this sequence one worships" means one makes offerings. "Oneself" is the form of Heruka. "With praises" means that by the goddesses described before, who have become producers of sound like echoes, one is to be wholly delighted, that is, satisfied, as follows. On "You, surrounded by the assembly of yoginīs as companions," and so on: you are surrounded by the assembly of yoginīs; by a mind whose nature comprehends that, you have attained the supreme, that is, you have received the command to protect sentient beings. Hence, when you are present, you make beautiful the world of the moving and the unmoving. The meaning is that you are worshipped because the afflictions are completely exhausted. The great being who has been permitted to abide as lord of mind awakens beings and makes the elaborations of illusion fall away. "Vajra" is a vocative, meaning indivisible wisdom. On "Be pleased," and so on: become fully delighted; "Heruka Vajra" is a vocative. At the end of the praise one recites oṃ sarbbatathāgatastutiravajresvabhāvātmako'haṃ. The intention is: from the very nature of abiding in the three realms.

Now, in order to reverse the habituation, from beginningless time, to the tendency toward physical food, the enjoyment of nectar through the yogin's application of meditative concentration is taught: "Having tasted the nectar," and so on. The rite for it is this. In front, one visualizes a wind maṇḍala transformed from the syllable yaṃ, and above it fire blazing from the repha. Above the blaze is a lotus vessel born from the syllable a, and within it are the four-equal perfume, musk and camphor, endowed with the supreme breath, which are one's own body, speech and mind. One performs the purification and the rest in the order in which the three syllables arose: having purified with hūṃ, awakened with āḥ and made it blaze with oṃ, one blesses it again with just those three syllables. Then one emanates the eight goddesses described before from the seed of the wisdom being at one's own heart; they take up the vessel of nectar; one visualizes at one's own heart the circle of the maṇḍala described before, and tastes the nectar with the tip of the hūṃ vajra. This is the rite. As it is also said:

"Then, in the lotus vessel resting on wind and fire, the self-arisen, the four-equal perfume, musk and camphor, endowed with the supreme breath, are purified by hūṃ and the white vajra, fully awakened by the syllable āḥ, and blessed and consecrated by the praṇava as having a blazing appearance. With

that white vajra arisen from hūṃ, the lotus petal of one's own tongue, one should fully satisfy the form whose nature is outer and inner."

It is also said in the explanatory tantra: "Breath, blaze, and in the skull cup: the nectar is to be tasted with the tongue that has arisen properly from the five seeds of the five fingers, by glorious Vajra Heruka." oṃ sarbbatathāgatāmṛtasvādanavajrasvabhāvātmako'haṃ.

In this way the meditation on the six limbs culminating in the tasting of nectar is taught. As it is also said in the Pañjara Tantra:

"Make love with the vajra;
Meditate on the abode of the buddhas;
Empowerment, and tasting the nectar;
Offering and praise: these are the six limbs.
Swiftly, together with accomplishments, it is attained
By the yogin who meditates on the six limbs."

"The celestial palace is the Buddha Vairocana;
Empowerment is the Tathāgata Akṣobhya;
Tasting the nectar is Amitābha;
Praise is glorious Ratnasambhava;
Offering is always said to be Amogha;
Passionate union is Vajrasattva."

In this way the assignment of the six limbs should also be understood:

"First one should meditate on black;
Second, meditate on red;
Third, one should meditate on yellow;
Fourth, likewise, on green;
In the fifth, the color blue;
And in the sixth, a white body.
The yogin should meditate on the six limbs,
Likewise ending with the joy of cessation."

Having thus meditated on the generation stage through this very meditation on the six limbs, immediately afterward, through the completion stage, one should focus on the signs of wisdom, and rest in the ultimate, free from all conceptual elaboration. As it is said in the explanatory tantra:

"The six limbs bring it about.
When this is accomplished,

First it appears like clouds;
Second, it is like smoke;
Third, it has the aspect of a glow in the sky;
Fourth, it is a blazing lamp;
In the fifth, there is constant appearance
Like a cloudless sky.
After that, the aspect like an illusion
And like a dream changes in an instant.
By Caṇḍālī blazing at the navel
The five Tathāgatas are burned;
Locanā and the others, the five, are burned;
The hare-marked moon is burned, and the haṃ drips."

Here, if one asks what one should do when tired from meditating on reality, the text says, "Preceded by emanation and withdrawal," and so on. One should do the mantra recitation that is preceded by emanation and withdrawal: from the three syllables of body, speech and mind one emanates the tathāgatas outward in the form of glorious Heruka, and having emanated them, one makes offerings properly. Then those, wholly transformed by the three syllables into the form of mantra bodies, are drawn back inside and firmly placed in one's own body, speech and mind vajras. Having done emanation and withdrawal in this way, one recites the mantra, that is, one recites the three-syllable mantra. "Thoroughly" means "do it thoroughly": steadily, in the sequence of entering, abiding and arising, constantly, day and night. "With one-pointed mind": this explains the sequence of counts, such as twenty thousand, without lapse of mindfulness in the inner sessions. That is the mantra recitation.

Regarding "dwelling in the moon at the heart of the wisdom being," and so on: it is this, the bindu at the heart of the wisdom being who dwells in the yogin's breast. There, the seed is explained as Heruka; going to that bindu, that is, entering it, it abides. The intent is that one should emanate again by arising as the three-syllable mantra explained before. The oral instruction here is this. The oṃ āḥ hūṃ dwelling at the forehead, the throat and the heart are the three realms; one imagines these signs of confidence as body, speech and mind. The line of the light rays of wisdom that arise from the heart of the wisdom being is drawn in by applying the downward-clearing wind, and gradually the syllable oṃ dissolves into the syllable āḥ, the syllable āḥ into the

syllable hūṃ, and the syllable hūṃ too is placed within the wisdom being, into the seed called the samādhi being. Then that too, gradually: the āḥ into the syllable ha, the syllable ha into the head, and that into the bindu whose nature is emptiness. Having meditated on that portion, the bindu alone, as naturally luminous, the dharmakāya of the Blessed One, glorious Heruka, one should again, from that mere bindu, in order to act for the benefit of beings, gradually emanate the dancer, the mantra body, appearing as mind, speech and body that are mere reflections.

"From the nature," that is, from recollecting the essential nature: one should understand this as the natural recitation. Regarding "the garland of mantras," and so on, the intent is this. Pervading everything with the lamps of light of the wisdom being at one's heart, one sees the entire realm of sentient beings, without exception, obscured by every affliction. Then, within the garland of mantras emanated from the seed at one's heart, there are the garlands of letters, oṃ deva picu vajra and so on, blazing with the qualities of luminous wisdom, in the forms and colors of countless activities such as pacifying. These very ones accomplish the benefit of all sentient beings: "having emanated outward, they perform the work of sentient beings." By this is meant going outward, that is, they have gone. The yogin who knows the four kinds of meaning of mantra binds the life wind and the downward-clearing wind very tightly; having bound them, he should emanate again and place them in his own heart. That is the meaning. "Otherwise the yogin will die": this should be understood as the samaya recitation.

Regarding "having recited," and so on: whatever merit has been accumulated by performing the three kinds of recitation in this way, all of it should be fully dedicated and given away so that sentient beings may attain the unsurpassed fruit.

Regarding "when arising from samādhi," and so on: when the yogin is tired from samādhi, then, on arising from meditative concentration, he should also wholly abandon distraction toward other things and read, that is, recite, this aspiration that brings about the attainment of buddhahood, which will now be set forth.

Regarding "born into the family," and so on: "into the family" means born into the family of bodhisattvas. Likewise, "free of madness" means one who conducts himself with conscientiousness. "Keeping the commitment" means having the approach of the samaya, that is, maintaining the awakening mind

as the cause of accomplishing the natural aim. "Teaching Hevajra" means teaching the path of the nature of reality, in which wisdom and skillful means are nondual. "Loving" means a mind moistened with compassion toward beings tormented by the three kinds of suffering. "Devoted to the guru" means holding him to be Vajradhara in person; and from the word "also," honoring one's spiritual friends. "Birth after birth" means in all births: may it be so until reaching the essence of awakening.

Regarding "in the hands, vajra and bell," and so on: the vajra symbolizes the awakening mind. The bell is of the nature of the Perfection of Wisdom. The hands that are marked by these, compassion and wisdom, are what is so described. Others read "ringing," meaning also the reading aloud of the profound Dharma. The queen is emptiness, and her fluid is the complete preservation of the arising of the seed of awakening.

Moreover, "drinking properly" means consuming completely, which is to say preserving completely. By this, may one be of that kind, birth after birth.

Regarding "Then the rites of torma and so on," and the rest: "then" means immediately after that. For the sake of accomplishing one's desired aims, and in order to pacify obstructors, one should offer torma to all the bhūtas. By the word "and so on," the fire offering, the worship of the maṇḍala and the like are taught. Here the torma should be described following the sequence of the explanatory tantra:

"Dwelling in the center of the region of space,
One should meditate on an eight-petaled lotus.
Having imagined Indra on the eastern petal,
Place Antaka in the south.
On the western petal is Varuṇa;
Likewise in the north, Kubera.
In the fire quarter, likewise, great Agni;
In Nairṛti's quarter, the eater of corpses.
Having imagined Vāyu in the wind quarter,
In Īśāna's quarter, the lord of bhūtas.
The moon, the sun, Brahmā and the other gods,
The supreme Brahmapurohita gods, and
Those dwelling in Tuṣita and in Yāma,
Those born of the Great Kings,
The Paranirmitavaśavartin gods, and

The gods of Nirmāṇarati,
Whoever dwell in the Pure Abodes,
Those dwelling in bliss in Sukhāvatī,
And those dwelling in Akaniṣṭha:
All of these, above,
Should be imagined seated in the center of a source of phenomena.
Karkoṭa and Śaṅkhapāla,
Likewise Ananta and Vāsuki,
Takṣaka and Kulika,
Mahāpadma and the excellent Padma.
In the lower sources of phenomena, too,
Are the asuras and the hell beings.
From oṃ come Brahmā and the others;
From hūṃ, the Fragment-Taker and the others;
From āḥ, Karkoṭa and the others.
They have one face and two arms.
The gods above are white;
Brahmā and the others appear black;
Karkoṭa and the others are deep red.
They are embraced by consorts like themselves,
And hold vajra and bell in their hands.
With the right leg extended they abide on their seats.
Brahmā and the others are sealed by the Eternal One;
Śatakratu and the others by the Vajra Holder;
Karkoṭa and the others by the Infinite One.
All of them are born from the three families.
Gaurī should summon them;
Caurī should make them enter;
Vetālī binds them with the chain;
Ghasmarī acts with cymbal and bell.
Having offered water for welcome and water for the feet,
One should then prepare this varied torma.
One should imagine maṇḍalas of wind and fire.
The lotus, arisen from a, is heated there by the blazing fire;
One prepares the torma with these portions of the five nectars;
Having imagined this, one blesses it with the praṇava."

inda jama jala jakkha bhūta bahni bāu rākkha canda sujja māda bappa tala patāla aṣṭa sappa svāhā idaṃ baliṃ bhuñja jighra phūlla dhūppa māṃsa pigaṃ ambha kājja sadā khanti khuṇi pheṭa gāda oṃ akāro mukhaṃ sarbbadharmmaṇāṃ ādyanutpannatvāt oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā

Then, the request to depart:

oṃ bajrasatva samayamanupālaya bajrasatva tvenopatiṣṭha dṛḍho me bhava sutoṣyo me bhava śāśvato ma bhava anurakto me bhava hrīdaya me adhitiṣṭha sarbbasiddhimme prayaccha sarbbakārmasu ca me cittaṃ śreyaḥ kuru hūṃ ha ha ha ha hoḥ bhagavāna sarbbatathāgatabajra mā me muñca mahāsamayatva aḥ

The rites of the maṇḍala, the fire offering and so on should be performed following what the excellent ones have upheld.

Regarding "for the sake of rest," and so on: "for the sake of rest" means in order to turn back from the net of external conceptual thought. As before, in the manner taught above, one performs all three kinds of recitation, together with the mantras of the maṇḍala deities. "According to the rite" is to be understood with its particulars, such as the unbroken limbs.

In this way the two bodies of the Blessed One have been fully shown through the nature of the day. Now, to explain the dharmakāya, free of all conceptual elaboration, so that one may meditate on what is taught through the symbol of the night, the nature of wisdom, emptiness without parts, whose characteristic is non-appearance, without any object at beginning or end, the text says, "At the end, entering the wheel at the heart." "The heart" is the bindu of the wisdom being. "The wheel" is what was emanated as the sun, that is, the wheel of the maṇḍala. "Entering" means one should cause it to enter completely. "At the end" means immediately following the day. That at night one should sleep with a nature in which wisdom and skillful means are nondual and of one taste is to be understood by implication. "Whose self is wisdom and means" is a qualifier of the maṇḍala wheel, by virtue of the inseparability of emptiness and compassion. Because it is the very continuum of great bliss, it is bliss; as in the saying "a butter lamp is life," here the effect is ascribed to what is the cause of life. "Its self is wisdom and means, and it is also bliss": this is a karmadhāraya compound. Or else, because self-aware bliss arises from it, the maṇḍala too is bliss. As it is said:

"The empowerment of the Great Seal
Is wisdom just as it is, great bliss.

Because that very thing arises from it,
The maṇḍala arises from the other."

By "bliss is red, bliss is yellow, bliss is green, bliss," and so on, the very nature of self-awareness of the maṇḍala wheel is made known. That is the rite of sleeping.

Showing the turning back from entry into the ultimate, the text says, "Urged by songs," and so on. Awakened by being urged by the songs of Pukkasī and the others, early, at the time of dawn, one should, "by the rite explained," that is, by the five aspects taught before, through the sequence of manifest and complete awakening, arise from the form in which the characteristic of emptiness is vividly manifest, with the very nature of the two bodies, the sambhogakāya and the nirmāṇakāya, and abide in the conduct of one who has so arisen. That is the meaning. "When capacity is found" means having obtained the power of meditation. "Completely" means one should undertake, that is, accomplish, the benefit of sentient beings irreversibly and without fault.

Regarding "having done this, virtuous," and so on: "this" refers to the treatise, that is, "by this." The virtue is the cause of nirvāṇa. It is a "blissful sādhana" because it has been fully set out without hardship. "The means of accomplishing awakening" is such a sādhana: it accomplishes the great bliss of all sentient beings without exception, that is, it accomplishes self-aware wisdom.

"Having done this sādhana," that is, having performed it: "By whatever virtue, stainless," that is, free of stains, without fault, "has been accumulated, by that virtue may beings," that is, those of the three realms, "attain the sky," that is, complete clarity. This means: may they attain the accomplishment of moving through the sky.

Whatever virtue I have gathered by writing this Lamp of Wisdom,
By that merit may the lamp of wisdom of sentient beings blaze brightly.
I have made it solely in accordance with King Jangchub Ö;
How could this commentary on difficult points not be a cause of understanding for those of weak intellect?

This completes the commentary on the means of accomplishing Vajra, composed by the Kashmiri Silver Vase.

It was translated by the great paṇḍita of eastern India, the elder and bodhisattva called Vanaratna, who had truly touched the dust of the feet of the Blessed One, glorious Vajrayoginī, together with the translator Shönu Pal.

Though I have not long been familiar with Sanskrit,
Still, to restore the tradition of the holy ones of old,
I have undertaken works such as this;
May the learned of the present day be patient with it.

Translator's Notes

• The list of the three bodies reads "enjoyment mantra" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), which makes no sense; it is translated as the evident reading "complete enjoyment" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), the enjoyment body. Similarly □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□, "aspiration prayer." The substance "rice-born" (□□□□□□□□□□□) is translated literally, as its identification is uncertain; "storax" renders □□□□□ (Skt. sihla), and "the four equal parts" is a perfume compounded of four ingredients in equal measure. The lemma □□□□□□, glossed as "at a certain spot of ground," is obscure as written and is rendered from the gloss. The final section lays out the classical four preliminaries of a commentary: subject matter, purpose, relation, and ultimate purpose.
• The words of the quoted sūtra to Subhūti end with □□□□□ ("known"), where the familiar sense would be "empty by their own nature"; the text is translated as it stands. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is unclear; it is taken as beings suffering from karmic results and the like. In "the others ranged before him" (□□□□□), the sense is inferred from context. The goddess verse follows the Hevajra Tantra, where Ḍombinī embraces the lord; "the elixir" renders □□ (rasa).
• In the opening gloss, □□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□, "unmoving," pairing with "moving"; and the vajra "□□□" is read as □□□□, "hammer." The phrase "a pair, form and its lord" for the first mantra word is obscure as written and is translated literally. The water maṇḍala arises here from paṃ as the text has it. The clause on summoning the intermediate-state being with the two hoḥ syllables into the womb is compressed and rendered by its evident sense.
• The clause on why the māras' forms are imagined (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is compressed; it is rendered as destroying people's belief in their birth. The grammatical remark on "diligence" refers to the dropping of a first member of a compound; the example "true fear" is translated literally.
• The opening grammatical remark is compressed; the sentence "it is not merely the wisdom of the utterly pure dharmadhātu" renders a plain negative (□□□□□□□□□□□) as the text has it. □□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□, "primordially." "Thing rubbed and thing rubbing" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, read as forms of □□□□□. bola and kakkola are the secret terms for the male and female organs.
• In the quoted verse on the directions, □□□ is read as □□□ (Varuṇa's quarter, the west) and □□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□ (Kubera's quarter, the north), as the sequence of directions requires; □□□□□□□ is taken as Indra's quarter (east) with Gaurī (□□□□□□). In "melting is the attainment of sameness," the written □□□□□□□ ("mire-ness") makes no sense and is read as □□□□□□□ (sameness). □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□, the dark blue (central) face. □□□□□□□ is taken as a name for Pukkasī, since it heads the four corner goddesses.
• "Confounding dull-witted people" reads □□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□ (dull, sunk); the phrase is uncertain. "Mounted upon the back of Time" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; the reference (perhaps to the māras ridden by the deity, mentioned earlier) is unclear. "Like the weapon of

Indra" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) may allude to the rainbow as a formless appearance; the construction is uncertain. In the tantra verse, "reciting mantra with the winds" construes □□□□□□□□□□ with the following line. Ratneśa and Amogha render □□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□ (Ratnasambhava and Amoghasiddhi).

• In the objection, □□□□□□□ ("practice") is read as □□□□□□□ ("purify") in both occurrences, as the argument requires. The five kinds of form of the dharma sense source correspond to the Abhidharma categories of extremely subtle form, form with spatial occasion, form arising from vows, imputed form and form arising from mastery. The commentary gives twenty-five kinds of tangible, which is kept as written.

• ḍittha and ḍibittha are the grammarians' stock examples of arbitrary names with no etymological meaning; the point is that "tathāgata" is a meaningful term. "Gone thus" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□. "In the form of Heruka" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, as the gloss ("with the bodies of Heruka") requires. "In the sky" reads □□□ as □□□□. "Whatever form there is" reads □□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□.

• "Should be kept in mind; that is the intention" reads □□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□. "The four-equal perfume" renders □□□□□□□ (catuḥsama), a perfume of four ingredients in equal parts; "the self-arisen" (□□□□□□□) and "the supreme breath" are likely coded terms for bodily substances in the nectar rite and are translated literally. The Pañjara Tantra (□□□) is the Ḍākinīvajrapañjara, the explanatory tantra of the Hevajra cycle.

• "Amogha" is kept as in the preceding pieces; it stands for Amoghasiddhi. "The joy of cessation" renders dga' bral (viramānanda). In the dissolution of hūṃ, the text as it stands says the āḥ dissolves into the ha; one would expect the vowel mark of hūṃ, but the reading is translated as written.

• "The Fragment-Taker" renders dum bus blangs pa literally; it heads the group of world protectors arising from hūṃ and may stand for Ākhaṇḍala, an epithet of Indra, but this is not certain. "The Eternal One" (Śāśvata) and "the Infinite One" are the family lords sealing the three groups, presumably Vairocana and Amitābha, with the Vajra Holder as Akṣobhya. Ro langs among the four gate goddesses is taken as Vetālī, and za nus as Ghasmarī. "What the excellent ones have upheld" renders bzang po yongs su 'dzin pa, which may be the title of a ritual work I cannot identify. "A butter lamp is life" follows the text as written; the usual example of this figure is "ghee is life." Las 'dzin pa'i bsdu ba is taken as the grammatical term karmadhāraya.

• The author's name, dngul gyi bum pa, is translated literally as "Silver Vase," since I cannot confirm its Sanskrit form (perhaps Rajatakalaśa or Rūpyakalaśa). "Lamp of Wisdom" may be the author's name for this commentary. "Means of accomplishing Vajra" follows the colophon as written, which abbreviates Hevajra.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.